Mark every MCP tool read-only, destructive or idempotent before agents use it

For SaaS teams making their API agent-ready. Notes from Oryva, the SDK generator we are building (pre-release).

Three of the MCP spec's tool hints tell an agent how careful to be

01 **readOnlyHint**

The tool does not change anything.

02 **destructiveHint**

The tool may delete or overwrite data. A client can ask a person first.

03 **idempotentHint**

A second identical call does nothing extra, so a retry after a timeout is safe.

Leaving a hint out is not neutral

> **If a tool is not marked read-only, the MCP spec assumes it may be destructive.**
>
> The default for destructiveHint is true. A client should never decide based on hints from a server it does not trust.

Source: MCP specification, schema reference, 2025-06-18

Oryva sets the hints from the spec and leaves deprecated operations out

01 **Write calls named delete, remove or cancel**

These are marked destructive.

02 **Deprecated operations**

These stay out of the generated MCP server, so agents never see them.

Source: Oryva commit history, github.com/Hopline-AI/oryva, 2 Nov 2026

Lint the server for agent problems before an agent ever runs

01 **Missing descriptions**

An agent picks tools by their descriptions.

02 **Destructive tools not marked destructive**

The hint a client relies on is missing.

03 **Retired tools still exposed**

An agent will keep calling what it can see.

04 **Context cost**

Each description uses model context.

Source: oryva eval --lint-only, Oryva README

Which of your API calls would you not want an agent to retry?

We build developer infrastructure, SDKs and agentic systems, end to end.

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